

Search Operator Cheatsheet

Essential search operators for advanced Google, Bing, and general search engine queries. Mastering these operators dramatically improves OSINT collection efficiency. Use the syntax column for exact format, then see examples for real usage.

Core Search Operators

Operator	Syntax	Description	Example
site:	site:example.com	Limit results to a specific domain	site:linkedin.com "software engineer"
filetype:	filetype:ext	Find files of a specific type	filetype:pdf osint report
intitle:	intitle:keyword	Keywords must appear in title	intitle:"investigation report"
inurl:	inurl:keyword	Keywords must appear in URL	inurl:admin login
intext:	intext:keyword	Keywords must appear in body text	intext:"confidential" filetype:pdf
cache:	cache:url	View Google's cached version	cache:example.com/page
link:	link:url	Find pages linking to a URL	link:example.com
related:	related:url	Find similar websites	related:nytimes.com
info:	info:url	Get page info from Google index	info:example.com
daterange:	daterange:start-end	Filter by date (Julian format)	daterange:2459000-2459100 breach
* (wildcard)	query * term	Wildcard for any word(s)	"data * occurred" breach
- (minus)	query -term	Exclude a term from results	security -breach
OR	query OR term	Include either term	osint OR open-source investigation
"" (quotes)	"exact phrase"	Exact phrase match	"classified document" pdf
around(N)	query AROUND(N) query	Words within N words of each other	breach AROUND(5) data

Advanced Search Tips

- 1) Combine operators: site:example.com intitle:report filetype:pdf
- 2) Use parentheses for complex queries: (breach OR leak) AND (data OR information)
- 3) The wildcard * only works in quoted phrases in Google
- 4) Julian date converter needed for daterange: - use online tools
- 5) cache: may return outdated or unavailable pages
- 6) link: and related: have limited functionality in modern Google
- 7) Try the same operators on Bing, DuckDuckGo, and Yandex - results vary

Quick Reference - Common Use Cases

Find leaked credentials: filetype:xls intext:password OR intext:username site:pastebin.com

Find exposed documents: intitle:confidential OR intitle:classified filetype:pdf -site:gov

Profile discovery: site:facebook.com inurl:profile intitle:"firstname lastname"

Email harvesting: intext:@company.com site:github.com OR site:pastebin.com

Server info: intitle:"index of" inurl:backup OR inurl:admin

Historical data: Use cache: or Wayback Machine (archive.org) for deleted content